

the experience of working in teams. Also, open source projects attract contributors from all across the globe and so working on these projects is one of the very effective channel of learning how to work in a multicultural work environment. The employers value this skill in individuals and your resume always stand out when they see your credentials in a open source project.

Other benefits of working in open source involves making contacts. When you participate in discussion forums, your questions and responses are read by many other community members and you gain respect in the community for your participation. People in the community start recognizing you and you also get to meet new people, who are aware of your skills. Many of the community members may be working for different organisation, and would recommend you for a relevant job opening in their organization. Once you get to know other members in the community very well, they may even refer you to their friends in the industry. Getting a job, and that too a well paying one, would be least of your problems if you have substantial contributions to open source.

Quick Tip

QuickTip: Whenever posting to a discussion forum, please maintain the forum etiquette. Using SMS like language is frowned upon, and asking questions, which has already been asked before shows that you have not done your home work. Make sure that you google for the answer you are looking for and then only throw it open for discussion in a forum, when you do not find it elsewhere.

OpenSolaris community is a good choice to start contributing to open source. The community is very well structured, and <http://www.opensolaris.org> is a common home for the community. Almost all of projects of OpenSolaris community is hosted here and so it makes it very simple for people to find where to start and how to begin. The community members are also very friendly and there are many support groups available. Biggest challenge one faces in contributing to open source is in understanding the community process. In OpenSolaris community, every process is well documented and every project and contribution is adjudged only on its merits in a democratic way. Create an account at <http://www.opensolaris.org> and experience it for yourself!

7.2 Career as a System / Network Administrator

If you are not one of those is deeply interested in writing code, but you like managing networks, security and systems, then a career in system administration or network administration will be a good choice. This will require you to have a good command over networking or system administration which you can learn by reading documentations and